Duality IV: Farkas' Lemma and LP Optimality Conditions

Can the constraints be satisfied? Farkas' lemma gives a short certificate when the answer is no.

Is a feasible point optimal? LP optimality conditions combine feasibility and complementary slackness.

We apply these ideas to fractional knapsack and a finite-state financial model.

Reading: Bertsimas–Tsitsiklis §4.6. Complete proofs and supplementary examples

From a failed dual-simplex row to a contradiction

Suppose a dictionary for nonnegative variables contains

$$x_3 = -1 - 2x_1 - 3x_2.$$

Rearrange that row:

$$\underbrace{2x_1 + 3x_2 + x_3}_{\geq 0} = -1.$$

Every term on the left is nonnegative. No feasible point can satisfy this equation.

Next: Can we obtain an impossible equation directly by combining the original constraints?

Can we prove infeasibility directly from the original constraints?

Consider a new example with nonnegative variables:

$$5x_1 + x_2 + 3x_3 = 1, \qquad 3x_1 + x_2 = 2, \qquad x \geq 0.$$

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 5 & 1 & 3 \\ 3 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad b = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

We ask only whether both equalities can hold. There is no objective to optimize.

> Subtract the second equality from the first. What equation must every feasible point satisfy?

A subtraction proves there is no feasible point

$$5x_1 + x_2 + 3x_3 = 1, \qquad 3x_1 + x_2 = 2, \qquad x \geq 0.$$

$$(5x_1 + x_2 + 3x_3) - (3x_1 + x_2) = 1 - 2$$

$$2x_1 + 3x_3 = -1.$$

The left side is nonnegative. The right side is negative. Therefore the constraints are inconsistent with nonnegative variables.

A vector records which equations we combined

$$5x_1 + x_2 + 3x_3 = 1, \qquad 3x_1 + x_2 = 2, \qquad x \geq 0.$$

The vector $q = (1, -1)^\top$ records the multipliers: first equality times 1, second equality times -1, then add.

$$q^\top A = (2, 0, 3) \geq 0, \qquad q^\top b = 1 - 2 = -1.$$

$$0 \leq 2x_1 + 3x_3 = q^\top A x = q^\top b = -1.$$

We call q an **infeasibility certificate**: it records how combining the constraints gives an impossible equation for $x \geq 0$.

The same certificate separates the target from the columns

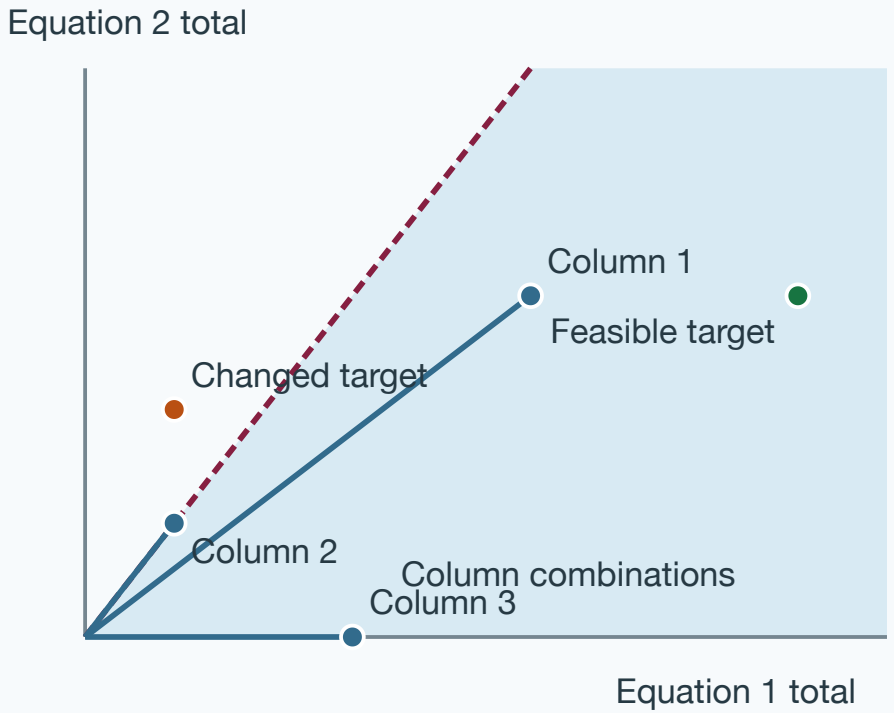
Columns: $A_1 = (5, 3)$, $A_2 = (1, 1)$, $A_3 = (3, 0)$; target $b = (1, 2)$.

A feasible point would express b as a nonnegative combination of columns:

$$b = x_1 A_1 + x_2 A_2 + x_3 A_3.$$

> Each column has first coordinate minus second coordinate nonnegative. So does every nonnegative combination.

The target $(1, 2)$ has difference -1, so it lies outside that cone.



Dashed line: the two totals are equal. The green target $(8, 3)$ is attainable; the orange target $(1, 2)$ is not.

Theorem 4.6: Farkas' lemma

Let $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^m$.

Feasible system

$$\text{There exists } x \geq 0 \text{ with } Ax = b.$$

Infeasibility certificate

$$\text{There exists } q \in \mathbb{R}^m : \quad A^\top q \geq 0, \quad b^\top q < 0.$$

The entries of q are unrestricted. The two alternatives cannot both hold, and one must hold.

Proof in the appendix

Practice: verify a certificate

Use the same A, but now $b = (2, 3)^\top$:

$$5x_1 + x_2 + 3x_3 = 2, \qquad 3x_1 + x_2 = 3, \quad x \geq 0.$$

> Try $q = (1, -1)^\top$. Compute $A^\top q$ and $b^\top q$. What do they prove?

Write the resulting scalar equation as well as the matrix products.

The certificate is a checkable contradiction

$$A^\top q = (2, 0, 3)^\top \geq 0, \qquad b^\top q = 2 - 3 = -1 < 0.$$

$$2x_1 + 3x_3 = -1 \quad \text{is impossible for } x \geq 0.$$

For the old target $b = (8, 3)^\top$, the same q gives $b^\top q = 5$. It is not an infeasibility certificate there.

Indeed, $x = (1, 0, 1)$ gives $Ax = (8, 3)^\top$: the old system is feasible.

Why a certificate rules out every feasible point

Suppose a certificate q satisfies $A^\top q \geq 0$ and $b^\top q < 0$.

$$\underbrace{(A^\top q)^\top x}_{\geq 0 \text{ when } x \geq 0} = q^\top A x = q^\top b < 0.$$

This contradiction excludes every nonnegative solution of the equalities.

The deeper part of Farkas' lemma is existence: whenever the system is infeasible, some such vector can be found. Phase I and duality prove that part.

Read the existence proof

A useful alternative for inequality systems

For $Ax \le b$ with x unrestricted, exactly one holds:

$$\exists x : \; Ax \le b.$$

$$\exists q \ge 0 : \; A^\top q = 0, \quad b^\top q < 0.$$

Nonnegative row multipliers preserve each inequality direction. The zero column product cancels every variable.

Derivation from the equality version

Cancel an unrestricted variable

$$x \geq 2, \quad x \leq 1 \qquad \Longleftrightarrow \qquad -x \leq -2, \quad x \leq 1.$$

Add both inequalities, using $q = (1, 1)$:

$$0 = (-x) + x \leq -2 + 1 = -1.$$

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad A^\top q = 0, \quad b^\top q = -1.$$

This version needs cancellation because an unrestricted variable could otherwise make either sign of contribution.

From “no feasible point” to “no better feasible point”

Farkas certificate: a combination of constraints proves infeasibility.

Optimality certificate: a dual feasible point gives a bound; a primal feasible point attains it.

We now collect the conditions for this matching bound in one place. They are the linear-programming form of the Karush–Kuhn–Tucker (KKT) conditions.

LP KKT conditions in standard form

Primal: $\min c^\top x$ subject to $Ax = b,\ x \geq 0$. Dual variable p is unrestricted.

Define the **dual slack** $s = c - A^\top p$.

Condition	Equation or inequality
Primal feasibility	$Ax = b, \quad x \geq 0$
Dual feasibility	$A^\top p + s = c, \quad s \geq 0$
Complementary slackness	$x_j s_j = 0 \quad \text{for every } j$

> A pair satisfies these conditions exactly when it is a primal–dual optimal pair.

Why these conditions are sufficient and necessary

For inequality rows, include their slacks too

Primal: $\min c^\top x,\ Ax \geq b,\ \ x \geq 0$. Dual: $\max b^\top p,\ A^\top p \leq c,\ \ p \geq 0$.

Define primal slack $r = Ax - b$ and dual slack $s = c - A^\top p$.

$$x, p, r, s \geq 0, \qquad Ax - b = r, \qquad c - A^\top p = s.$$

$$p_i r_i = 0 \text{ for every } i, \qquad x_j s_j = 0 \text{ for every } j.$$

An inactive primal constraint has positive slack, forcing its dual variable to zero. A positive primal variable forces its dual constraint to be active.

Application: fractional knapsack

Let x_j be the fraction of item j taken. Fractions are allowed, so $0 \le x_j \le 1$.

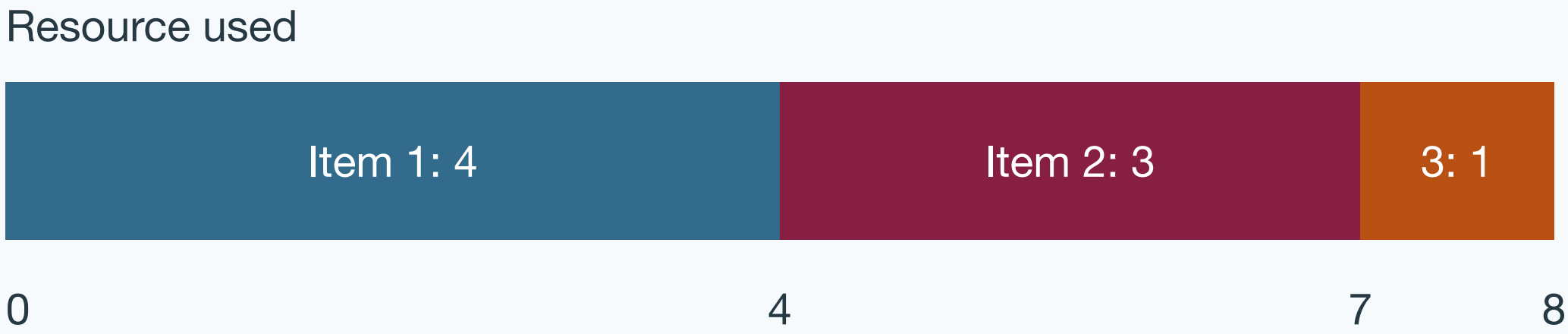
Item	1	2	3	4
Resource per item	4	3	2	5
Value per item	20	12	6	10
Value / resource	5	4	3	2

Maximize $20x_1 + 12x_2 + 6x_3 + 10x_4$, with $4x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 + 5x_4 \le 8$ and $0 \le x_j \le 1$.

> How should we allocate 8 resource units to maximize value?

Take higher value per resource first

Maximize $20x_1 + 12x_2 + 6x_3 + 10x_4$, with $4x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 + 5x_4 \le 8$ and $0 \le x_j \le 1$.



Item 3 uses 2 resource units when taken in full; one remaining unit buys half of it.

$$x^* = \left(1, 1, \tfrac{1}{2}, 0\right), \qquad c^\top x^* = 20 + 12 + 3 = 35.$$

We took items 1 and 2 completely, then half of item 3. How can we certify that 35 is optimal?

Build an upper bound on the value

Write the model as $\max c^\top x,\ a^\top x \le 8,\ 0 \le x \le \mathbf{1}$.

Choose a capacity dual variable $\beta \ge 0$ and upper-bound dual variables $\delta_j \ge 0$ satisfying $\beta a_j + \delta_j \ge c_j$.

$$c^\top x \le \sum_j (\beta a_j + \delta_j) x_j \le 8\beta + \sum_j \delta_j.$$

$$\min\ 8\beta + \sum_j \delta_j \quad \text{s.t. } \beta a_j + \delta_j \ge c_j, \quad \beta, \delta \ge 0.$$

The first inequality uses nonnegative fractions. The second uses the capacity and the upper bounds.

A matching bound proves optimality

Maximize $20x_1 + 12x_2 + 6x_3 + 10x_4$, with $4x_1 + 3x_2 + 2x_3 + 5x_4 \le 8$ and $0 \le x_j \le 1$.

Choose $\beta = 3$ and $\delta = (8, 3, 0, 0)$.

Item	1	2	3	4
$\beta a_j + \delta_j$	20	12	6	15
c_j	20	12	6	10

$$8\beta + \sum_j \delta_j = 24 + 8 + 3 = 35 = c^\top x^*.$$

Both points are feasible and their objective values agree. They are optimal.

Check each complementary-slackness product

At $x^* = (1, 1, \frac{1}{2}, 0)$, $\beta = 3$, $\delta = (8, 3, 0, 0)$, define dual slack $\gamma_j = \beta a_j + \delta_j - c_j$.

Restriction	Slack	Dual variable / product
Capacity	$8 - a^\top x^* = 0$	$\beta \cdot 0 = 0$
$x_j \le 1$	$1 - x^* = (0, 0, \frac{1}{2}, 1)$	$\delta_j(1 - x_j^*) = 0$
Dual constraint	$\gamma = (0, 0, 0, 5)$	$x_j^* \gamma_j = 0$

The partly used item has neither bound active, so its value per resource equals the capacity dual variable: 6/2 = 3.

The dual variable predicts value within a valid range

Keep $a = (4, 3, 2, 5)$, $c = (20, 12, 6, 10)$, but change capacity from 8 to b. Let $V(b)$ be the maximum total value at that capacity.

$$7 \le b \le 9: \quad x = \left(1, 1, \frac{b-7}{2}, 0\right), \quad V(b) = 11 + 3b.$$

One extra resource unit adds value 3 while item 3 remains the marginal item. The same certificate $\beta = 3, \delta = (8, 3, 0, 0)$ still works.

At $b = 10$, item 4 is partly used: $x = (1, 1, 1, \frac{1}{5})$, $V = 40$, and $\beta = 2$. The old slope cannot be extrapolated forever.

General greedy proof and boundary cases

Application: prices and future payoffs

Let c_j be today's price of asset j. Let R_{ij} be its payoff in future state i.

A portfolio h has initial cost $c^\top h$ and state-payoff vector Rh. Each h_j is unrestricted: a negative holding means short selling.

An **arbitrage** has $c^\top h \leq 0$, $Rh \geq 0$, with at least one strict inequality.

It requires no net initial investment, never loses in a listed future state, and gives a strictly positive benefit somewhere.

This is a finite-state, frictionless mathematical model.

An explicit portfolio reveals inconsistent prices

$$R = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad c = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Buy one unit of asset 1 and sell one unit of asset 2: $h = (1, -1)^\top$.

$$c^\top h = 1 - 2 = -1, \qquad Rh = \begin{pmatrix} 2-1 \\ 1-1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

You receive 1 initially and have nonnegative future payoffs. This is an arbitrage with strictly negative initial cost.

Can future-state prices explain today's asset prices?

Now consider a different market with two assets and two future states.

$$R = \begin{pmatrix} 70 & 50 \\ 30 & 50 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad c = \begin{pmatrix} 50 \\ 40 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Define p_i as the price assigned to one unit paid only in state i. Matching both asset prices requires

$$R^\top p = c \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad 70p_1 + 30p_2 = 50, \quad 50p_1 + 50p_2 = 40.$$

$$p_1 + p_2 = \tfrac{4}{5}, \quad 40p_1 = 26, \quad p = \left(\tfrac{13}{20}, \tfrac{3}{20}\right) > 0.$$

These are state prices, not probabilities; they need not sum to 1.

Positive state prices rule out arbitrage

Suppose $R^\top p = c$ with every $p_i > 0$. Then every portfolio satisfies

$$c^\top h = (R^\top p)^\top h = p^\top (Rh).$$

If $Rh \geq 0$, its cost is nonnegative. If at least one state payoff is positive, its cost is strictly positive.

So a portfolio with nonnegative payoffs cannot have negative cost, or zero cost with a positive payoff. There is no arbitrage.

The converse and complete theorem

Farkas explains the alternative

Apply Farkas' lemma to the unknown state-price vector p:

$$\exists p \geq 0 : \quad R^\top p = c.$$

$$\text{or} \quad \exists h : \quad Rh \geq 0, \quad c^\top h < 0.$$

Exactly one holds. Thus nonnegative state prices rule out arbitrage with a strictly negative initial cost.

For the broader definition including free positive payoffs, the corresponding no-arbitrage condition is strictly positive state prices.

Why a zero state price needs care

Three uses of the same duality logic

Question	What to exhibit
Is the equality system infeasible?	$A^\top q \geq 0,\ b^\top q < 0$
Is a feasible point optimal?	A feasible dual point with the same value, or the KKT conditions.
Are the asset prices arbitrage-free?	Strictly positive state prices reproducing every asset price.

> Always state the model, the variable signs, and the precise conclusion before interpreting a certificate.

Next: sensitivity analysis changes the data while tracking feasible bases and valid optimality certificates.

Appendix: proofs and further calculations

- Farkas’ lemma from Phase I and duality
- The inequality alternative and finding a certificate
- LP KKT conditions and fractional-knapsack proof
- Seven-item fractional-knapsack example
- No-arbitrage theorem and the role of positivity
- Risk-neutral probabilities, replication, and completeness

Farkas proof 1: normalize the right-hand side

First assume $b \geq 0$. If a row has $b_i < 0$, multiply that entire equality by -1.

> Let D be diagonal with entries ± 1, chosen so $Db \geq 0$. The transformed system is $DAx = Db$.

A certificate $\tilde{q}$ for the transformed system gives a certificate for the original system by setting $q = D\tilde{q}$:

$$A^\top q = (DA)^\top \tilde{q} \geq 0, \qquad b^\top q = (Db)^\top \tilde{q} < 0.$$

It is therefore enough to prove existence for a nonnegative right-hand side.

Farkas proof 2: solve the auxiliary problem

With $b \geq 0$, Phase I is

$$\min \ \mathbf{1}^\top y \quad \text{s.t. } Ax + y = b, \quad x, y \geq 0.$$

> It is feasible at $x = 0, y = b$, and its objective is bounded below by zero. Therefore it has an optimal solution.

If the optimum is zero, then $y = 0$ and $Ax = b, x \geq 0$ is feasible.

If the original system is infeasible, the Phase I optimum is strictly positive.

Farkas proof 3: the Phase I dual gives the certificate

The dual of $\min\{\mathbf{1}^\top y : Ax + y = b,\ x, y \geq 0\}$ is

$$\max\ b^\top u \quad \text{s.t. } A^\top u \leq 0, \quad u \leq \mathbf{1}, \quad u \text{ unrestricted.}$$

When the original system is infeasible, strong duality gives an optimal u with $b^\top u > 0$.

$$q = -u \quad \Longrightarrow \quad A^\top q \geq 0, \qquad b^\top q < 0.$$

This proves a certificate exists. The contradiction identity in the main slides proves the two alternatives are mutually exclusive.

Derive the inequality alternative

For unrestricted x, write $x = x^+ - x^-$, with $x^+, x^- \geq 0$, and introduce $s \geq 0$:

$$Ax \leq b \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad Ax^+ - Ax^- + s = b.$$

The equality-form certificate for the columns $[A, -A, I]$ requires

$$A^\top q \geq 0, \quad -A^\top q \geq 0, \quad q \geq 0, \quad b^\top q < 0.$$

$$A^\top q = 0, \quad q \geq 0, \quad b^\top q < 0.$$

This also proves existence, rather than merely showing how to check a proposed vector.

Finding a certificate is itself an LP feasibility problem

Any certificate with $b^\top q < 0$ can be rescaled by the positive number $-1/(b^\top q)$.

$$A^\top q \geq 0, \qquad b^\top q = -1, \qquad q \text{ unrestricted.}$$

So we can search for a certificate using linear equalities and inequalities. A successful solution proves infeasibility; a Phase I solve is another way to obtain one.

The normalization -1 is convenient, not an extra assumption on the original system.

LP KKT proof: the objective gap is a sum of products

For primal–dual feasible points in $\min\{c^\top x : Ax \geq b, x \geq 0\}$, set $r = Ax - b \geq 0$, $s = c - A^\top p \geq 0$, $p \geq 0$.

$$c^\top x - b^\top p = x^\top s + p^\top r = \sum_j x_j s_j + \sum_i p_i r_i.$$

If all products vanish, the feasible objective values agree, so both points are optimal by weak duality.

If both points are optimal, strong duality makes the gap zero. Every summand is nonnegative, so every product vanishes.

For equality rows, r = 0 identically and p is unrestricted. The same identity leaves only the variable–dual-slack products.

Fractional knapsack: define the threshold item

Consider $\max c^\top x$, $\sum_j a_j x_j \le b$, $0 \le x_j \le 1$, with $a_j > 0, c_j \ge 0$. Sort so $c_1/a_1 \ge \cdots \ge c_n/a_n$.

Assume $0 < b < \sum_j a_j$. Choose k so $\sum_{j<k} a_j \le b \le \sum_{j \le k} a_j$.

$$x_j^* = \begin{cases} 1 & j < k, \\ (b - \sum_{i<k} a_i)/a_k & j = k, \\ 0 & j > k. \end{cases}$$

This is feasible and fills the capacity. At an exact boundary, the selected threshold fraction may equal 0 or 1.

Fractional knapsack: construct a matching dual solution

Set $\beta = c_k/a_k$ and $\delta_j = \max\{c_j - \beta a_j, 0\}$.

Then $\beta, \delta \geq 0$ and $\beta a_j + \delta_j \geq c_j$: dual feasibility holds.

$$b\beta + \sum_j \delta_j = b\beta + \sum_{j<k} (c_j - \beta a_j)$$

$$= \sum_{j<k} c_j + c_k \frac{b - \sum_{j<k} a_j}{a_k} = c^\top x^*.$$

The matching values prove the greedy allocation is optimal.

Tied ratios may allow several optimal allocations; they do not invalidate this certificate.

Fractional knapsack: ties and boundary capacities

Case	A valid optimal choice
$b = 0$	$x = 0$; choose $\beta = \max_j c_j/a_j$, $\delta = 0$.
$b \geq \sum_j a_j$	$x = \mathbf{1}$; choose $\beta = 0$, $\delta = c$.
Equal value / resource	Exchange resource among tied items within their bounds without changing the objective.

If $b < 0$, the model with $a > 0, x \geq 0$ is infeasible. The sorting proof above assumed $c \geq 0$; negative-value items can be omitted when capacity is only an upper bound.

Seven items: a larger fractional-knapsack example

A bag has capacity 100. Items can be divided.

Item	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Size	25	20	15	10	30	10	20
Value	150	100	80	70	140	110	90
Value / size	6	5	$16/3$	7	$14/3$	11	$9/2$

Order by value per size: 6, 4, 1, 3, 2, 5, 7. The first five use 80 units; take 20/30 of item 5.

$$x^* = (1, 1, 1, 1, \tfrac{2}{3}, 1, 0), \qquad c^\top x^* = \frac{1810}{3}.$$

Seven items: verify the dual bound

For sizes $a = (25, 20, 15, 10, 30, 10, 20)$, values $c = (150, 100, 80, 70, 140, 110, 90)$, and capacity 100, choose

$$\beta = \tfrac{14}{3}, \qquad \delta = (\tfrac{100}{3}, \tfrac{20}{3}, 10, \tfrac{70}{3}, 0, \tfrac{190}{3}, 0).$$

Every component of $\beta a + \delta - c$ is zero except the seventh, which equals $10/3$. Thus the dual is feasible.

$$100\beta + \sum_j \delta_j = \tfrac{1400}{3} + \tfrac{410}{3} = \tfrac{1810}{3}.$$

The bound equals the value of the allocation on the preceding page.

Why nonnegative state prices are not always enough

$$R = I_2, \qquad c = (1, 0)^\top, \qquad p = (1, 0)^\top.$$

We have $R^\top p = c$ and $p \geq 0$, so no portfolio can have both $Rh \geq 0$ and $c^\top h < 0$.

> But $h = (0, 1)^\top$ costs zero and pays $(0, 1)^\top$. It is an arbitrage under the broader definition.

A zero state price can ignore a positive payoff in that state. Strict positivity excludes that possibility.

No-arbitrage theorem: encode every possible gain

For a finite number of states and unrestricted portfolios, define

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} R \\ -c^\top \end{pmatrix}, \qquad v = Mh.$$

The vector v lists all future payoffs followed by the initial receipt. Arbitrage means v is nonnegative and nonzero.

> Rescaling gives an equivalent system:
>
> $$Mh - v = 0, \qquad \mathbf{1}^\top v = 1, \qquad v \geq 0, \quad h \text{ unrestricted}.$$

The market has no arbitrage exactly when this system is infeasible.

No-arbitrage theorem: apply Farkas to the gain system

Apply Farkas to $Mh - v = 0,\ \mathbf{1}^\top v = 1$, replacing unrestricted h by $h^+ - h^-$.

A certificate consists of u for the first equations and a scalar t for the last one:

$$M^\top u = 0, \qquad -u + t\mathbf{1} \geq 0, \qquad t < 0.$$

Thus $u \leq t\mathbf{1} < 0$. Put $\lambda = -u > 0$; then $M^\top \lambda = 0$.

$$R^\top \lambda_{1:m} = c\lambda_{m+1} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad p = \lambda_{1:m}/\lambda_{m+1} > 0, \quad R^\top p = c.$$

Combined with the main-slide identity, this proves: no arbitrage if and only if strictly positive state prices exist.

Fractional knapsack: why an exchange improves value

Suppose item i has strictly greater value per resource than item j, but $x_i < 1$ and $x_j > 0$.

Transfer $\varepsilon = \min\{a_i(1 - x_i), a_j x_j\} > 0$ resource units from item j to item i.

$$x_i' = x_i + \varepsilon/a_i, \qquad x_j' = x_j - \varepsilon/a_j.$$

$$c^\top x' - c^\top x = \varepsilon \left(\frac{c_i}{a_i} - \frac{c_j}{a_j} \right) > 0.$$

Bounds remain satisfied and resource use is unchanged. Therefore an optimum cannot use a lower-ratio item while leaving room in a strictly higher-ratio item. Tied ratios allow value-preserving exchanges.

Fractional knapsack with arbitrary upper bounds

For $\max c^\top x$, $a^\top x \le b$, $0 \le x_j \le u_j$, assume $a_j > 0$, $u_j > 0$.

> Set $t_j = x_j / u_j$. Then $0 \le t_j \le 1$, with new sizes $a_j u_j$ and values $c_j u_j$. Their ratios remain c_j / a_j.

$$\min \; b\beta + \sum_j u_j \delta_j \quad \text{s.t. } \beta a_j + \delta_j \ge c_j, \quad \beta, \delta \ge 0.$$

The upper-bound complementary product is $\delta_j (u_j - x_j) = 0$. Items with $u_j = 0$ are fixed at zero and can be removed.

Normalize state prices to obtain a probability vector

With strictly positive state prices p, define $C = \sum_i p_i$ and $\pi_i = p_i / C$. Then $\sum_i \pi_i = 1$.

$$c_j = \sum_i p_i R_{ij} = C \sum_i \pi_i R_{ij}.$$

In our two-state example, $p = (13/20, 3/20)$, so $C = 4/5$ and $\pi = (13/16, 3/16)$.

These risk-neutral probabilities reproduce asset prices. They need not describe the actual likelihood of future states. If a unit payoff in every state is traded or replicated, C is its price.

Price a new payoff by replicating it

Keep $R = \begin{pmatrix} 70 & 50 \\ 30 & 50 \end{pmatrix}$, $c = (50, 40)$. A new asset pays $d = (20, 0)$. Solve $Rh = d$.

$$70h_1 + 50h_2 = 20, \quad 30h_1 + 50h_2 = 0 \quad \Longrightarrow \quad h = (\tfrac{1}{2}, -\tfrac{3}{10}).$$

$$c^\top h = 25 - 12 = 13 = p^\top d.$$

If the new asset cost more than 13, sell it and buy this portfolio. If it cost less, buy it and sell the portfolio. Future payoffs cancel and the initial receipt is positive. Its arbitrage-free price must be 13.

Market completeness means every payoff can be replicated

With m future states, the market is **complete** when every $d \in \mathbb{R}^m$ can be written as Rh. This is equivalent to $\operatorname{rank}(R) = m$.

> Under no arbitrage, state prices satisfy $R^\top p = c$, $p > 0$. Full row rank of R makes this solution unique.

If rank is smaller than m, choose nonzero v with $R^\top v = 0$. For sufficiently small $\varepsilon > 0$, both $p + \varepsilon v$ and $p - \varepsilon v$ are positive and reproduce the same asset prices.

> Thus, under no arbitrage, completeness is equivalent to uniqueness of state prices. Incomplete markets admit several such vectors.

An incomplete market does not determine every new price

Suppose the only asset pays $(1, 1)$ and costs 1. State prices satisfy $p_1 + p_2 = 1, p_1, p_2 > 0$.

A new asset pays $d = (1, 0)$. Its price $k = p^\top d = p_1$ may be any value strictly between 0 and 1.

> At price 0, the new asset gives a free positive payoff. At price 1, buy the original asset and sell the new asset: zero cost, payoff (0,1). Both endpoints permit arbitrage.

The existing asset cannot replicate (1,0), so the old prices alone do not select one interior price.

A payoff bound is another primal–dual LP pair

To cover a target payoff d in every state, minimize the cost of an unrestricted portfolio h:

$$\min_{h} \; c^{\top} h \quad \text{s.t. } Rh \geq d.$$

Its dual is

$$\max_{p} \; d^{\top} p \quad \text{s.t. } R^{\top} p = c, \quad p \geq 0.$$

The equality dual constraints come from unrestricted holdings. If the covering problem is feasible and has a finite optimum, strong duality gives a matching state-price bound. A replicable payoff has the same price under every feasible state-price vector.